



Marketing Design System at BNY

Building and governing the design system behind BNY's marketing and demand-gen web and app products.

ROLE

VP User Experience

TIMELINE

Nov 2025 – Present

INDUSTRY

Financial Services

01

Context

BNY's Marketing Data & Demand Generation team runs a growing portfolio of public-facing websites and apps, most built on Adobe Experience Manager (AEM) and maintained with the help of an external digital agency. As the portfolio grew, so did inconsistency — new sites were being built with one-off components, with no shared source of truth for design decisions.

02

The Challenge

Design work was split between an internal team and an external digital agency handling business-as-usual work, with no shared component library to keep them

aligned. Every new AEM site risked drifting further from the last, and stakeholders across marketing, brand and engineering had no single place to validate design decisions against.

03

Research

Audited components already in use across existing AEM sites, ran requirement-gathering sessions with marketing and brand stakeholders, and worked directly with engineering to understand implementation constraints on AEM.

Stakeholder interviews

Design audits

Engineering workshops

Design critiques

04

Insights

The key findings that shaped the direction.

01

The agency needed a system, not just a spec

Handing over static designs to the digital agency for BAU work produced visible drift within weeks — they needed a governed, versioned library to build against.

02

AEM's constraints had to shape the system

Component decisions that looked simple in Figma weren't always simple to implement in AEM, so design and engineering had to define the system together.

03

Stakeholders needed a shared vocabulary

Requirement gathering moved much faster once marketing, brand and engineering could point to the same named components instead of describing them from scratch each time.

05

Design Strategy

How decisions were made.

01

Audit and align

Catalogued components already in use across BNY's marketing and demand-gen sites, then aligned with brand, marketing and engineering stakeholders on which patterns should become the system's foundation.

02

Design with AEM in mind

Worked closely with the engineering team from the outset so every component was validated against AEM's real implementation constraints, not just its visual design.

03

Partner with the agency

Built the system to be usable by the external digital agency handling day-to-day site work, not just the internal team, so consistency holds regardless of who's building.

04

Drive adoption, not just documentation

Run design critiques and office hours to get the system actually adopted across live AEM sites, rather than letting it sit unused in Figma.

06

Solution

A governed, AEM-aware design system for BNY's marketing and demand-gen properties, built collaboratively with engineering and usable by both the internal team and the external digital agency.

- ✓ A component library validated against real AEM implementation constraints
- ✓ A shared vocabulary and working process for internal team, agency and engineering
- ✓ An ongoing critique and adoption process embedded across live marketing sites

Design System Thinking

This project wasn't designed as a one-off — here's how it connects back to the system.



Components

A growing library of AEM-ready components, each validated with engineering before being handed to the digital agency for BAU builds.



Tokens

Foundational tokens aligned to BNY's brand guidelines, giving marketing and demand-gen sites a consistent visual baseline.



Patterns

Reusable page and section patterns that reduce how much new sites need to be designed from scratch.



Governance

A critique and requirement-gathering process that keeps the internal team, the digital agency and engineering working from the same source of truth.

Impact

The system is now the shared foundation for new AEM builds across BNY's marketing and demand-gen portfolio, giving the internal team, the digital agency

and engineering a single source of truth to design, validate and build against.

Ongoing

Rollout across AEM sites

3

Teams aligned: internal,
agency, engineering

1

Shared design system

09

Reflection

This role is a reminder that a design system's hardest problem usually isn't the components — it's getting a distributed set of people, an internal team, an external agency and engineering, to actually build against the same source of truth. Getting the working process right matters as much as the Figma file.